Finding the Right Electric Razor

The latest wet/dry electric shavers detect the density of hairs, cool down skin, and flex to fit the contours of your face. But which is most worthy of shearing your stubble?

by **JEFF FOSS**

RATED (1 to 10)

Panasonic ES-LV95-S Arc5

$600; shop.panasonic.com

If money is no object, then this is the razor to buy. The Panasonic features a five-blade cutting system that detects the density of your stubble and adjusts the power accordingly. It's quiet and easy to guide, combining close-cutting precision with the maneuverability of a pivoting neck. In a single pass it obliterated everything from a sandpapery five-o'clock shadow to those hard-to-snip flat-lying hairs. A bright LCD screen displays battery life and a cleaning reminder; the rubberized grip is easy to hold. By far the best of the bunch.

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Braun CoolTec CT5cc

$200; braun.com

This shaver is outfitted to eradicate skin irritation: Sandwiched between its blades is an aluminum panel that drops to a face-cooling temperature as soon as the power button is pressed. The idea is that the cooler your skin, the less likely it is to redden. It's a neat trick, and we certainly felt the cooling effect during every shave. But the additional tech adds more weight and noise: The CT5cc was the loudest and least maneuverable of the group. If you have sensitive skin, it's a worthy option.

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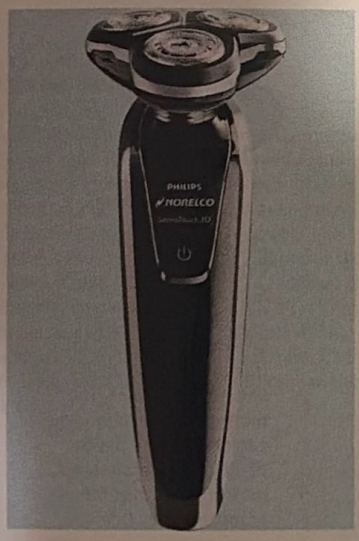

Philips-Norelco Series 8000

$250; usa.philips.com

Not only does it have a stealthy look and a hushed motor, but this shaver also handily neutralized all whiskers. Aided by a head that nimbly flexes, tilts, and pivots, the patented cutting system sliced our stubble to below skin level for a smooth, even shave. It earns bonus points for its 50-minute run time and its easy-to-read battery-level screen. To nitpick, we wish the detailer were more prominent: It made squaring off sideburns difficult.

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Remington Hyper Series XR1330

$85; remingtonproducts.com

Cheeks, chin, jawline, upper lip, Adam's apple — this lightweight shaver handled every part of our face we put in its path. While it doesn't flex as freely as the Series 8000 or feel as frictionless as the Panasonic, its concentric head grooves captured errant hairs. Its pop-up detailer extends away from the device, which meant we could see it as we trimmed our sideburns. Plus, it has an admirable 40-minute run time. Bottom line: The XR1330 is an excellent combination of price and performance.

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A BETTER ELECTRIC SHAVE

A three-step, three-product guide to ensure your electric shave leaves you blemish-free.

1. Scrub Your Skin
The key to a smooth shave? Exfoliation. Unlike abrasive, machine-clogging scrubs, **Ursa Major Fantastic Face Wash** uses hydroxy acids to rid dead surface skin. *$26; ursamajormen.com*

2. Raise Your Hairs
The thin, liquid **Lab Series Electric Shave Solution** forces your follicles to stand upright, coats your skin with vitamin E, reduces the chance of irritation, and washes off easily. *$17; labseries.com*

3. Splash Your Face
Fight the effects of razor friction with **John Allan's Cool Face Aftershave Remedy**. Its mix of aloe vera, oat, chamomile, and vitamins noticeably reduces irritation. *$25; johnallans.com*

HOW WE TESTED IT We spent a month using the latest crop of electric shavers on a variety of faces covered with everything from thick stubble to light scruff. Shaving in both wet and dry conditions, we rated the contenders on performance, ease of use, and overall features.